VolunteerConnect

VolunteerConnect is a comprehensive platform designed to connect volunteers with meaningful opportunities, streamline event management, and enhance the overall volunteer experience. The platform features event discovery, team organization, attendance tracking, and AI-powered insights to maximize social impact.

✨ Features

Event Management

- **Event Creation & Discovery**: Organizers can create detailed event listings, and volunteers can easily find opportunities based on interests and location.
- **Team Management**: Form and manage volunteer teams with ease.
- **RSVP & Check-in**: Streamlined process for volunteers to sign up and check in at events.

Attendance Tracking

- **Verification System**: NGOs can verify attendance to award points.
- **Gamification**: Earn points and rank on the global leaderboard.
- **Impact History**: Volunteers can view their complete attendance history and impact metrics.

AI Enhancements (Gemini Integration)

- **Description Enhancement**: Automatically improves event descriptions to be more professional.
- **Smart Categorization**: Uses AI to categorize events into relevant fields.
- **AI Chatbot**: Helpful assistant for volunteering tips and platform help.

🚀 Installation & Setup

Follow these steps to get a local copy of VolunteerConnect running on your machine.

📋 Prerequisites

- **Node.js**: Download and install Node.js (v16 or higher recommended)
- **Git**: Download and install Git
- **Firebase Project**: A Firebase project with Firestore, Authentication, and Hosting enabled.
- **Google Cloud**: A project with Gemini API enabled.

🐧 Linux / macOS Setup

1. **Clone the Repository**:

```
git clone https://github.com/NireekshaAP07/VolunteerCOnnect.git
cd VolunteerCOnnect
```

2. **Backend Setup**:

```
cd backend
npm install
# Create .env and serviceAccountKey.json here (see Secrets section below)
npm run dev
```

3. **Frontend Setup** (Open a new terminal):

```
cd frontend
npm install
# Create .env here (see Secrets section below)
npm run dev
```

Windows Setup

1. **Clone the Repository**: Open Command Prompt or PowerShell:

```
git clone https://github.com/NireekshaAP07/VolunteerCOnnect.git
cd VolunteerCOnnect
```

2.**Backend Setup**:

```
cd backend
npm install
# Create .env and serviceAccountKey.json here (see Secrets section below)
npm run dev
```

3.**Frontend Setup** (Open a new terminal):

```
cd frontend
npm install
# Create .env here (see Secrets section below)
npm run dev
```

🔐 Secrets & Environment Variables

Since sensitive keys are not pushed to GitHub, you must manually restore them:

1. Backend (`/backend`)

Create a file named `.env`:

```
GEMINI_API_KEY=your_gemini_api_key
PORT=5000
```

Also, place your Firebase `serviceAccountKey.json` in the `/backend` folder.

2. Frontend (`/frontend`)

Create a file named `.env`:

```
VITE_FIREBASE_API_KEY="..."
VITE_FIREBASE_AUTH_DOMAIN="..."
VITE_FIREBASE_PROJECT_ID="..."
VITE_FIREBASE_STORAGE_BUCKET="..."
VITE_FIREBASE_MESSAGING_SENDER_ID="..."
VITE_FIREBASE_APP_ID="..."
VITE_GOOGLE_MAPS_API_KEY="..."
```

🛠️ Usage

1.Start the backend first (`npm run dev` in `/backend`).
2.Start the frontend (`npm run dev` in `/frontend`).
3.Open `http://localhost:5173` in your browser.

Project Structure

```
VolunteerConnect/
├── backend/              # Node.js/Express backend
│   ├── serviceAccountKey.json (Manual)
│   ├── .env (Manual)
│   └── index.js
└── frontend/             # React/Vite frontend
    ├── .env (Manual)
    └── src/              # App logic
```